

TOPEKA ROAD CONSTRUCTION TRACKER

City of Topeka + KDOT major road and bridge projects

Status date: September 8, 2026

Category	Verified count
Major projects reviewed	12
Construction definitely started and not finished	8
Design / pre-construction / status not clear enough to count	4
Confirmed completed among these 12	0
Started in 2025 or earlier and still active	6

Bottom line: Based on the major projects verified for this tracker, **at least 8 major Topeka-area road or bridge projects had physical construction underway and were still unfinished on September 8, 2026.** This is not a count of every small paving, sidewalk, curb, utility, or routine maintenance job.

Complete Major-Project Tracker

#	Project	Started	Target	Status
1	SW Topeka Blvd - 15th to 21st	2025	Winter 2026	STARTED - UNFINISHED
2	SE 6th - Golden to Rice	Oct. 6, 2025	Nov. 2026	STARTED - UNFINISHED
3	SW Fairlawn - about 22nd/23rd to 28th	Aug. 25, 2025	Oct. 2026	STARTED - UNFINISHED
4	SW Topeka Blvd - 29th to 37th	Sept. 8, 2026	Dec. 2027	JUST STARTED - UNFINISHED
5	SW Huntoon - McAlister to Gage	2026	Nov. 6, 2026	STARTED - UNFINISHED
6	I-70 Polk-Quincy Viaduct	Early 2025	Late 2027	STARTED - UNFINISHED
7	U.S. 24 - Kansas Ave to Muddy Creek	July 2023	2027	STARTED - UNFINISHED
8	California Ave bridge over I-70	2026	Late 2026	STARTED - UNFINISHED
9	SW Huntoon - Gage to Harrison	Design/development 2024	Construction 2027-29	ROAD CONSTRUCTION NOT STARTED
10	Central Highland Park Phase II	2026 program	Early fall 2026 target	STATUS NOT CLEAR ENOUGH TO COUNT
11	Oak Park / SE 42nd east of Adams	Design 2026	TBD	DESIGN / PRE-CONSTRUCTION
12	SW 57th - U.S. 75 to Topeka Blvd	Planning/design	TBD / multi-year	PRE-CONSTRUCTION / MIXED PROGRAM

Project Details

1. SW Topeka Boulevard - 15th to 21st

This project rolled over from 2025 and includes roadway reconstruction plus waterline and storm-sewer work. The City continued to identify it as an active 2026 project. Published project reporting placed the value at roughly \$8 million and anticipated completion in winter 2026. **Status:** started in 2025 and not finished as of the tracker date.

2. SE 6th Avenue - Golden to Rice

Construction began October 6, 2025. Work includes roadway improvements, the Deer Creek bridge, stormwater systems, the 6th/Golden intersection, curb and gutter, and ADA ramps. Contract information placed substantial completion around November 6, 2026 and final completion/payment around November 20, 2026. **Approximate construction duration:** about 13 months.

3. SW Fairlawn - about 22nd/23rd to 28th

The project includes street reconstruction, stormwater, waterline and sanitary-sewer work, Shunganunga Creek bridge repair, widening, and turn lanes. The announced August 18, 2025 start was pushed to August 25, 2025. That is a documented startup delay of about one week, but it does not by itself prove the final completion date is behind schedule. **Target:** October 2026.

4. SW Topeka Boulevard - 29th to 37th

Major construction began September 8, 2026. The work includes boulevard rehabilitation, reconstruction of major intersections, traffic-signal replacement, waterline work, storm sewer, and sanitary sewer. The reported project budget is about \$6.2 million. Traffic restrictions began with construction, and the overall project is expected to continue until December 2027. **Approximate construction period:** about 16 months.

5. SW Huntoon - McAlister to Gage

This is the active Huntoon pavement project west of Gage and is separate from the much larger future Gage-to-Harrison reconstruction. Reporting in early September said the project remained on schedule, with substantial completion and unrestricted reopening targeted for October 9, 2026 and final completion for November 6, 2026.

6. SW Huntoon - Gage to Harrison

Development/design began in 2024, but physical roadway construction was not scheduled to begin until spring 2027. During 2026 the work centered on design, easements/right-of-way, utility relocation, and project preparation. Recent reporting placed approved improvements at roughly \$26 million, with the larger construction program extending toward 2029. **This project is therefore not included in the count of eight physically active unfinished construction projects.**

7. I-70 Polk-Quincy Viaduct

This is the largest project in the tracker. KDOT lists the 2.5-mile project at approximately \$239 million, with construction beginning in early 2025 and expected completion in late 2027. Major 2026 work has included significant I-70 closures and ramp changes around downtown Topeka. On September 8, 2026, additional work affected the eastbound I-70 exit to Topeka Boulevard.

8. U.S. 24 - Kansas Avenue to Muddy Creek

KDOT's 5.5-mile U.S. 24 improvement project began in July 2023 and is expected to continue into 2027. The project is approximately \$64.4 million and includes pavement replacement, access improvements, frontage roads, and replacement of bridges over Soldier Creek and Muddy Creek. As of September 8, 2026, this is the oldest major active construction project in this tracker.

9. California Avenue Bridge over I-70

KDOT's California Avenue bridge replacement over I-70 is an approximately \$8 million project. Construction is active in 2026, with a late-2026 completion target. I-70 traffic beneath the bridge was affected beginning in August 2026 while the new bridge was being constructed.

10. Central Highland Park Phase II

The project has an approved budget of about \$2.35 million for Indiana Avenue between 21st and 25th. Bid/project material called for construction in 2026 with an early-fall target. A sufficiently current September status confirmation was not available in the information used for this report, so it is intentionally excluded from the confirmed-active total.

11. Oak Park / SE 42nd east of Adams

This project was associated with engineering/design work in 2026, including street-repair and stormwater assessment work. Because the available information did not clearly establish active physical road construction on September 8, it is classified as design/pre-construction rather than unfinished construction.

12. SW 57th - U.S. 75 to Topeka Boulevard

The corridor was highlighted for heavy pavement rehabilitation/replacement, but available information also reflects design work and a separate bridge component. Because the program contains mixed timing and the specific bridge work extends beyond 2026 in state programming, it is classified conservatively as pre-construction/mixed rather than counted as one of the eight confirmed active jobs.

Known Major-Project Costs

Project	Approx. reported cost
I-70 Polk-Quincy Viaduct	~\$239.0 million
U.S. 24 - Kansas Ave to Muddy Creek	~\$64.4 million
Huntoon - Gage to Harrison	~\$26.0 million
SW Topeka Blvd - 15th to 21st	~\$8.0 million
California Ave bridge over I-70	~\$8.0 million
SW Topeka Blvd - 29th to 37th	~\$6.2 million
Central Highland Park Phase II	~\$2.35 million

The known costs above total roughly **\$354 million**. This is not a complete total for all Topeka construction because dependable current costs were not identified for every project in the tracker, and smaller City/KDOT maintenance projects are excluded.

What the Count Means

The phrase **started but unfinished** in this report means physical road or bridge construction was verified as underway and the project had not reached completion by September 8, 2026. Design, engineering, utility relocation, right-of-way acquisition, and planning do not automatically qualify as physical construction. This distinction is why the future Huntoon Gage-to-Harrison project is not included in the eight-project total even though project development began in 2024.

Verified conclusion: At least eight major Topeka-area road/bridge projects were under physical construction and unfinished. At least six major projects affecting the area originated in 2025 or earlier. The U.S. 24 project is the oldest in this tracker, beginning in July 2023, while the approximately \$239 million Polk-Quincy Viaduct is the largest by reported cost.

Sources Used

City of Topeka - Public Works / project announcements
<https://www.topeka.org/>

City of Topeka - project files and Capital Improvement materials
<https://files.topeka.gov/>

KDOT - I-70 Polk-Quincy Viaduct
<https://www.ksdot.gov/projects/northeast-kansas-projects/i-70-polk-quincy-viaduct>

KDOT - U.S. 24 Improvements
<https://www.ksdot.gov/projects/northeast-kansas-projects/u-s-24-improvements-kansas-avenue-to-muddy-creek>

KDOT - California Avenue over I-70 bridge replacement
<https://www.ksdot.gov/projects/northeast-kansas-projects/california-avenue-over-i-70-bridge-replacement>

WIBW - Topeka 2026 public works and September construction reporting
<https://www.wibw.com/>

HigherGov - SE 6th contract information
<https://www.highergov.com/>

Note: This report reflects information assembled for September 8, 2026. Construction schedules, traffic phases, costs, and completion dates can change. Routine maintenance and smaller neighborhood/utility projects are not intended to be comprehensively counted here.